

Reading Review: Chapell

FA24_AT5532_Bronoske

Dennis Gahm

Overview of the Text

The overview of the book is that we should preach sermons that engage the audience and attack the core issue at hand. This is because so many sermons are boring and do not engage the audience and do not have the several qualities that the author is looking for. The author is looking for 1) a unified sermon. A sermon should revolve around a single theme and sentence that describes the focus of the sermon. This prevents people from preaching narrative passages of Scripture in just chronological order of the text. 2) FCF - a fallen condition focus. This is the fact that we are looking at the fallen aspect of humankind when we look at a passage and give a sermon, and that we need to give a sermon that addresses this fallen aspect and gives a solution with Jesus Christ. This fallen condition prevents cults from coming in and giving sermons about good works without the grace and forgiveness and love of Jesus Christ. 3) A redemptive quality. We should preach in a way that shows that the Bible is making us a complete person, well equipped to do good works. And that God is redeeming us from our past and from bad habits.

The author was conveying that there are many ways to make a sermon, but we need to engage the audience and attack the point at hand and make them understand they need to change with God's grace. We need to do the purpose of the sermon, not just do the motions. So many young preachers miss out on the punchline.

Key Points

- 1) Unified sermon. This was important. There are a lot of things to say during the sermon, but I need to scrap some of them. I need to revolve my sermon around

a peg, and then put more things on that peg. What that means is that the audience can only memorize and understand so much at a time. Thus, we need to put the message in an easy to understand format that is organized, like pegs. This point jumped out at me because I have experience giving a sermon and I lacked a focus and single theme. I also preached in a narrative type fashion for the Old Testament. I wish I could preach just a single verse in the OT passage.

- 2) FCF - Fallen Condition Focus. We must focus on the fallen aspect of human beings being conveyed in the passage at hand. There is a reason why we have the Bible - because we are fallen. Thus, in every exposition of a Biblical text, we should point out what the fallen condition in the text is, the fallen condition in us presently is, and the redemptive solution.

Personal Application

I was blessed to read this book. It reminded me of Howard Merrell, a preacher and President of my Bible college. I learned how to preach through him, and the practicality of his preaching and this book matches. I should engage the audience - not through flashy ornaments, but by pointing out the needs of the congregation and how to fix them through a redemptive look at Jesus Christ. Every sermon should be full of fun and engagement. I realize that I need to focus on just a few verses when giving a sermon. When the Bible says, "Let's love one another more!" I can point out our fallenness in not loving each other enough. I need to improve my walk with the Lord by trusting in his grace every day rather than in my works.